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30 Prompts for Paying Attention



One a day, for a slower month.

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HOW TO USE THESE

A slower month, one noticing at a time.

There are no rules. Only an invitation to look.

Attention is the quietest form of care — for our work, the people we love, and the ordinary hours that make up most of a life. These aren't a productivity system. They're thirty small nudges to look up, look closer, and write down one true thing before the day carries you off.

A gentle way in

- Take one prompt a day, in any order. A missed day isn't a broken streak — just begin again tomorrow.
- Write a single sentence or a full page. Whatever the day allows is exactly enough.
- Keep your answers somewhere you'll return to — a notebook, the margins of this page, a commonplace book of your own.
- Don't reach for the profound. The point is to notice what's already here.

Begin whenever you're ready. Take it slowly. — Jeannie

Week one Look

- 01** Write down the first thing you saw this morning, before you reached for your phone.

- 02** Describe the quality of today's light in a single sentence.

- 03** Notice one color you keep seeing today. Where did it turn up?

- 04** Look closely at something you use every day. What have you never noticed about it?

- 05** Find something small and lovely that no one else would photograph. Describe it.

- 06** Watch the sky for five minutes. Write only what changed.

- 07** What did you almost walk past today? Go back to it on the page.

Week two Listen

- 08** List the sounds around you right now, softest to loudest.
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- 09** Write down a sentence you overheard. Leave it exactly as it was said.
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- 10** What silence did you notice today — and what filled it?
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- 11** Recall a voice you love. What makes it that voice?
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- 12** Sit somewhere new for ten minutes and write only what you hear.
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- 13** What song, or bird, or engine marked an hour of your day?
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- 14** Write the last thing someone said that you're still thinking about.

Week three **People & Places**

I5 Describe a stranger you saw today in three honest lines.

I6 Write about a room you know by heart. Start at the doorway.

I7 What did a person's hands tell you about them today?

I8 Recall the first place that ever felt like yours.

I9 Notice a small kindness — given or received — and record it.

20 Describe the walk you take most often as if for the first time.

2I Who came to mind unexpectedly today, and why?

Week four Inward & Back

22 What feeling arrived today without being invited? Name it plainly.

23 Write down a worry, then write what it's actually asking for.

24 What did your body notice before your mind did today?

25 Finish this line: "I keep returning to..."

26 What did you make time for today, and what did you let go?

27 Write about a taste or a smell that carried you somewhere else.

28 What are you paying attention to now that you weren't a month ago?

29 Copy out a sentence worth keeping — from a book, a sign, a message.

30 Look back through the month. Which noticing surprised you most?

YOU ONLY GET ONE LIFE

The days go quickly
when we stop
noticing them.

Make it true.



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